EMPIRICISM

EMPIRICIST STARTING RULE AND → LOCKE'S SOURCE-OF-IDEAS PIPELINE AND → LOCKE'S ABSTRACTION, GENERAL IDEAS → LOCKE'S QUALITIES, REPRESENTATIVE REALISM → LOCKE'S KNOWLEDGE, PROBABILITY, SELF → BERKELEY'S ANTI-ABSTRACTION ROUTE TO

Read the thick cyan rail from Stage 00 to the final core synthesis. Each card uses a concept-appropriate structure; the grey E card is optional enrichment only and never repairs missing core content.

◆ PRIMARY CORE FLOW ◇ SUBORDINATE EXTRA ★ APPROVAL / REVIEW

CORE BEFORE EXTRA • prior artefacts unchanged • exact same master drives poster and tiles

Approval: FALSE • Pending user review • source generation g4 and all prior artifacts unchanged

00

STAGE 00

EMPIRICIST STARTING RULE AND LOCKE-BERKELEY-HUME PRESSURE SEQUENCE

EMPIRICIST STARTING RULE AND LOCKE-BERKELEY-HUME PRESSURE SEQUENCE · WHAT CAN EXPERIENCE ALONE JUSTIFY ABOUT WORLD, SELF, GOD · SENSATION + REFLECTION · REPRESENTED MATERIAL WORLD PRESSURE · RESEMBLANCE AND UNKNOWN SUBSTRATUM · SENSIBLE OBJECTS · IDEAS; ACTIVE SPIRITS; NO MATTER PRESSURE · WHAT EXPERIENTIAL SOURCE SUPPORTS SELF AND NECESSARY POWER?

CENTRAL QUESTION: WHAT CAN EXPERIENCE ALONE JUSTIFY ABOUT WORLD, SELF, GOD AND CAUSE? → LOCKE: sensation + reflection → ideas → represented material world pressure: resemblance and unknown substratum → BERKELEY: sensible objects = ideas; active spirits; no matter pressure: what experiential source supports self → HUME: impressions + ideas → custom / natural belief → mitigated scepticism → ROUTE: representative realism → immaterialism → sceptical naturalism.

DOCTRINE / CLAIM

- CENTRAL QUESTION: WHAT CAN EXPERIENCE ALONE JUSTIFY ABOUT WORLD, SELF, GOD AND CAUSE?
- LOCKE: sensation + reflection → ideas → represented material world pressure: resemblance and unknown substratum

OBJECTION / PRESSURE

- BERKELEY: sensible objects = ideas; active spirits; no matter pressure: what experiential source supports self and necessary power?
- HUME: impressions + ideas → custom / natural belief → mitigated scepticism

REPLY / RESIDUAL

- ROUTE: representative realism → immaterialism → sceptical naturalism.
- CENTRAL QUESTION: WHAT CAN EXPERIENCE ALONE JUSTIFY ABOUT WORLD, SELF, GOD AND CAUSE?

MECHANISM / VERDICT — Each thinker applies experiential scrutiny to a claim preserved by the previous system: material support, active spirit, continuing self or necessary connection.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Empiricism is not three disconnected biographies but a progressive test of what an experience-only foundation can justify: Locke retains represented matter, Berkeley replaces matter with ideas and spirits, and Hume limits reason to perceptions, custom and mitigated belief.

01

STAGE 01

LOCKE'S SOURCE-OF-IDEAS PIPELINE AND LIMITS OF KNOWLEDGE

LOCKE'S SOURCE-OF-IDEAS PIPELINE AND LIMITS OF KNOWLEDGE · REJECT INNATE CONTENT · NO UNIVERSAL ASSENT; NO CONSCIOUSLY UNPERCEIVED PROPOSITIONS · SENSATION (OUTER SENSE) + REFLECTION (MENTAL OPERATIONS) · SIMPLE IDEAS · PASSIVELY RECEIVED COMBINE · COMPLEX IDEAS · SENSITIVE; BEYOND IT LIES PROBABILITY

REJECT INNATE CONTENT: no universal assent; no consciously unperceived propositions

SENSATION (outer sense) + REFLECTION (mental operations) → SIMPLE IDEAS: passively received combine / compare / abstract → COMPLEX IDEAS: MODES

SOURCE / DOCTRINE

- REJECT INNATE CONTENT: no universal assent; no consciously unperceived propositions
- SENSATION (outer sense) + REFLECTION (mental operations)

ARGUMENT / MECHANISM

- SIMPLE IDEAS: passively received combine / compare / abstract
- COMPLEX IDEAS: MODES

IMPLICATION / VERDICT

- KNOWLEDGE: intuitive → demonstrative → sensitive; beyond it lies probability
- LIMIT: genetic explanation does not by itself defeat dispositional innatism.

MECHANISM / VERDICT — Experience supplies simple contents; after which mental operations build complex ideas without inventing any new simple sensory material.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Locke's empiricism is constructive rather than merely receptive: sensation and reflection provide simple ideas, while the understanding actively combines, compares and abstracts them into the complex materials of knowledge.

02

STAGE 02

LOCKE'S ABSTRACTION, GENERAL IDEAS AND REAL-NOMINAL ESSENCE

LOCKE'S ABSTRACTION, GENERAL IDEAS AND REAL-NOMINAL ESSENCE · PARTICULAR IDEAS · OMIT TIME/PLACE/CONCOMITANTS · GENERAL REPRESENTATIVE · GENERAL WORD · SIGNIFIES ABSTRACT GENERAL IDEA · CLASSIFIES PARTICULARS · NOMINAL ESSENCE

PARTICULAR IDEAS → omit time/place/concomitants → GENERAL REPRESENTATIVE

GENERAL WORD → signifies abstract general idea → classifies particulars → NOMINAL ESSENCE = abstract idea attached to the name → REAL ESSENCE = hidden internal constitution producing observable powers

SOURCE / DOCTRINE

- PARTICULAR IDEAS → omit time/place/concomitants → GENERAL REPRESENTATIVE
- GENERAL WORD → signifies abstract general idea → classifies particulars
- NOMINAL ESSENCE = abstract idea attached to the name

ARGUMENT / MECHANISM

- REAL ESSENCE = hidden internal constitution producing observable powers
- TRIANGLE PROBLEM: neither equilateral nor scalene, yet represents both
- BERKELEY: no contradictory abstract image; use a particular sign generally

IMPLICATION / VERDICT

- LOCKE REPLY: undetermined feature != contradictory feature
- RESIDUAL: non-imagistic abstraction strains Locke's official idea theory.

MECHANISM / VERDICT — A particular experiential idea becomes general by selective omission and stands for a class under a general name.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Lockean abstraction makes generality a work of the understanding rather than a feature of independently existing universals, but Berkeley exposes the tension between a general determinable and an impossible indeterminate image.

03

STAGE 03

LOCKE'S QUALITIES, REPRESENTATIVE REALISM AND UNKNOWN SUBSTRATUM

LOCKE'S QUALITIES, REPRESENTATIVE REALISM AND UNKNOWN SUBSTRATUM · SOLIDITY, EXTENSION, FIGURE, MOTION/REST, NUMBER; INSEPARABLE FROM BODY · COLOUR, SOUND, TASTE, SMELL, HEAT/COLD; POWERS RELATIVE TO PERCEIVERS · PRIMARY-QUALITY IDEAS RESEMBLE; SECONDARY-QUALITY IDEAS DO NOT · CAUSAL ACTION · IDEA IMMEDIATELY PERCEIVED · REPRESENTATION CLAIM · VEIL OBJECTION

SYSTEM / DOCTRINE	DECISIVE DISTINCTION	EVALUATION / TRAP
PRIMARY: solidity, extension, figure, motion/rest, number; inseparable from body	BODY → causal action → IDEA IMMEDIATELY PERCEIVED → REPRESENTATION CLAIM	EXACT LIMIT: 'something, I know not what' = unknown nature, not denied existence
SECONDARY: colour, sound, taste, smell, heat/cold; powers relative to perceivers	VEIL OBJECTION: how can an idea be compared with unperceived matter?	REPLY: causal/structural representation; RESIDUAL: support remains opaque.
RESEMBLANCE: primary-quality ideas resemble; secondary-quality ideas do not	SUBSTRATUM: supposed support of co-occurring qualities	

SYSTEM / DOCTRINE

- PRIMARY: solidity, extension, figure, motion/rest, number; inseparable from body
- SECONDARY: colour, sound, taste, smell, heat/cold; powers relative to perceivers
- RESEMBLANCE: primary-quality ideas resemble; secondary-quality ideas do not

DECISIVE DISTINCTION

- BODY → causal action → IDEA IMMEDIATELY PERCEIVED → REPRESENTATION CLAIM
- VEIL OBJECTION: how can an idea be compared with unperceived matter?
- SUBSTRATUM: supposed support of co-occuring qualities

EVALUATION / TRAP

- EXACT LIMIT: 'something, I know not what' = unknown nature, not denied existence
- REPLY: causal/structural representation; RESIDUAL: support remains opaque.

MECHANISM / VERDICT — External bodies causally produce ideas; primary-quality ideas allegedly resemble their causes, while repeated co-instantiation motivates the supposition of a support.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Locke's representative realism secures an external world by the resemblance of primary-quality ideas, yet its unknown substratum and mediated perception generate the very gap that Berkeley turns against matter.

04

STAGE 04

LOCKE'S KNOWLEDGE, PROBABILITY, SELF, MEMORY AND DEMONSTRATIVE GOD

LOCKE'S KNOWLEDGE, PROBABILITY, SELF, MEMORY AND DEMONSTRATIVE GOD · PERCEIVED AGREEMENT/DISAGREEMENT OF IDEAS; PROBABILITY GUIDES BELIEF · SAME PERSON · CONTINUITY OF CONSCIOUSNESS AND APPROPRIATION THROUGH MEMORY · SAME HUMAN BEING · CONTINUITY OF ONE LIVING ORGANISM · SAME SUBSTANCE · SAMENESS OF MATERIAL OR IMMATERIAL BEARER

DOCTRINE / CLAIM

- KNOWLEDGE = perceived agreement/disagreement of ideas; probability guides belief
- SAME PERSON: continuity of consciousness and appropriation through memory
- SAME HUMAN BEING: continuity of one living organism

OBJECTION / PRESSURE

- SAME SUBSTANCE: sameness of material or immaterial bearer
- PRINCE/COBBLER: person follows consciousness; man follows organism
- BUTLER: memory presupposes identity; REID: Brave Officer breaks transitivity

REPLY / RESIDUAL

- REPAIR: overlapping psychological-continuity chains
- GOD: finite knowing existence → demonstrative causal route; no innate God-idea
- LIMIT: repaired continuity exceeds a simple episodic-memory criterion.

MECHANISM / VERDICT — Conscious appropriation links present and past experiences for accountability, while demonstrative reasoning moves from existing knowing being to an eternal powerful cause.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Locke's account unifies epistemic humility and forensic identity: knowledge has bounded degrees, while the person extends only as far as consciousness can appropriate past thought and action.

05

STAGE 05

BERKELEY'S ANTI-ABSTRACTION ROUTE TO IMMATERIALISM AND DIRECT REALISM

BERKELEY'S ANTI-ABSTRACTION ROUTE TO IMMATERIALISM AND DIRECT REALISM · NO ABSTRACT GENERAL IMAGE · MATERIAL SUBSTANCE-IN-GENERAL LOSES CONTENT · LIKENESS PRINCIPLE · AN IDEA CAN BE LIKE ONLY AN IDEA · QUALITY PARITY · OBSERVER-RELATIVITY APPLIES TO PRIMARY AND SECONDARY QUALITIES · SENSIBLE OBJECT

NO ABSTRACT GENERAL IMAGE → material substance-in-general loses content → LIKENESS PRINCIPLE: an idea can be like only an idea → QUALITY PARITY: observer-relativity applies to primary and secondary qualities → SENSIBLE OBJECT = stable collection of immediately perceived ideas → ESSE EST PERCIPI applies to sensible things; IDEAS are passive

DOCTRINE / CLAIM

- NO ABSTRACT GENERAL IMAGE → material substance-in-general loses content
- LIKENESS PRINCIPLE: an idea can be like only an idea
- QUALITY PARITY: observer-relativity applies to primary and secondary qualities

OBJECTION / PRESSURE

- SENSIBLE OBJECT = stable collection of immediately perceived ideas
- ESSE EST PERCIPI applies to sensible things; IDEAS are passive
- SPIRITS perceive and act; they are not themselves ideas

REPLY / RESIDUAL

- DIRECT-REALIST DIMENSION: no unknowable material duplicate behind experience
- TRAP: immaterialism denies matter, not experienced tables, trees or order.

MECHANISM / VERDICT — If all sensible qualities are ideas and no idea can resemble an unperceiving material original, matter adds no intelligible content to experienced objects.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Berkeley's immaterialism does not abolish experienced reality; it abolishes the unexperienced material duplicate behind it, turning anti-abstraction and the likeness principle into a direct-realist attack on Locke's representational veil.

06

STAGE 06

BERKELEY'S SPIRITS, GOD, WORLD-CONTINUITY AND OBJECTION LEDGER

BERKELEY'S SPIRITS, GOD, WORLD-CONTINUITY AND OBJECTION LEDGER · FINITE SPIRITS RECEIVE INVOLUNTARY SENSORY IDEAS; IMAGINATION IS WEAKER/VOLUNTARY · PASSIVE IDEAS CANNOT CAUSE; ACTIVE CAUSATION BELONGS TO SPIRIT · INFINITE SPIRIT CAUSES STABLE, COHERENT AND SHARED SENSORY ORDER · OBJECT CONTINUITY DOES NOT DEPEND ON CONTINUOUS HUMAN OBSERVATION · ACTIVE SPIRIT KNOWN BY NOTION, NOT BY A COPIED · SOLIPSISM REPLY · MANY FINITE SPIRITS + COMMON DIVINE ORDER

DOCTRINE / CLAIM

- FINITE SPIRITS receive involuntary sensory ideas; imagination is weaker/voluntary
- PASSIVE IDEAS cannot cause; active causation belongs to spirit
- GOD / INFINITE SPIRIT causes stable, coherent and shared sensory order

OBJECTION / PRESSURE

- OBJECT CONTINUITY does not depend on continuous human observation
- SELF: active spirit known by NOTION; not by a copied idea
- SOLIPSISM REPLY: many finite spirits + common divine order

REPLY / RESIDUAL

- ILLUSION REPLY: coherence, involuntariness and correction within experience
- RESIDUAL: experienced order does not uniquely demonstrate Berkeley's God.

MECHANISM / VERDICT — Involuntary, vivid and coherent sensory ideas form a law-like order whose active cause cannot be a passive idea and is attributed to God.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Berkeley avoids solipsism by making finite perceivers recipients within a divinely ordered language of nature: God is neither an idea nor another human observer but the active cause of stable sensory order.

07

STAGE 07

HUME'S IMPRESSIONS, IDEAS, FORK, SUBSTANCE, BUNDLE SELF AND RELIGION LIMITS

HUME'S IMPRESSIONS, IDEAS, FORK, SUBSTANCE, BUNDLE SELF AND RELIGION · IMPRESSIONS (FORCEFUL) · IDEAS (FAINTER COPIES) · COPY PRINCIPLE · EVERY SIMPLE IDEA NORMALLY TRACES TO A SIMPLE IMPRESSION · MISSING SHADE OF BLUE IS A NARROW ACKNOWLEDGED EXCEPTION · CAUSE AND EFFECT · HUME'S FORK

PERCEPTIONS → IMPRESSIONS (forceful) / IDEAS (fainter copies)

COPY PRINCIPLE: every simple idea normally traces to a simple impression → QUALIFICATION: missing shade of blue is a narrow acknowledged exception → ASSOCIATION: resemblance

SOURCE / DOCTRINE

- PERCEPTIONS → IMPRESSIONS (forceful) / IDEAS (fainter copies)
- COPY PRINCIPLE: every simple idea normally traces to a simple impression
- QUALIFICATION: missing shade of blue is a narrow acknowledged exception
- ASSOCIATION: resemblance

ARGUMENT / MECHANISM

- cause and effect
- HUME'S FORK: relations of ideas / matters of fact
- SUBSTANCE: no distinct impression beyond a collection of qualities/perceptions
- SELF: bundle in flux; memory/association generate identity fiction

IMPLICATION / VERDICT

- APPENDIX DIFFICULTY: Hume cannot explain genuine unity among perceptions
- GOD/RELIGION: design analogy and divine predicates exceed demonstrative certainty.

MECHANISM / VERDICT — Ideas inherit content from impressions; associative imagination connects them, but neither branch of the Fork supplies a perceived substance or a demonstrative inference to transcendent being.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Hume transforms empiricism into a forensic method: when substance, self or divine predicates cannot supply an originating impression or a valid inferential route, their speculative certainty is reduced without denying the natural beliefs of common life.

08

STAGE 08

HUME'S CAUSATION, INDUCTION AND CUSTOM LOOP

HUME'S CAUSATION, INDUCTION AND CUSTOM LOOP · ONE CASE · PRIORITY + CONTIGUITY + SUCCESSION; NO IMPRESSION OF NECESSARY · CONSTANT CONJUNCTION; OBJECTS REVEAL NO NEW TIE · CUSTOM CHANGES THE MIND · FELT TRANSITION FROM A TO EXPECTED B · IMPRESSION OF REFLECTION PROJECTED ONTO OBJECTS · CAUSE 1

SOURCE / DOCTRINE

- ONE CASE: priority + contiguity + succession; no impression of necessary power
- REPETITION: constant conjunction; objects reveal no new tie
- CUSTOM changes the mind → felt transition from A to expected B

ARGUMENT / MECHANISM

- NECESSITY = impression of reflection projected onto objects
- CAUSE 1: regularly conjoined objects; CAUSE 2: one idea determines another
- INDUCTION assumes future resembles past / nature is uniform

IMPLICATION / VERDICT

- NO DEMONSTRATION: contrary is conceivable
- NO NON-CIRCULAR EXPERIENCE PROOF: past success already uses induction
- VERDICT: practice is natural and indispensable, but not rationally necessitated.

MECHANISM / VERDICT — Observed regularity conditions the imagination to move from cause-idea to effect-idea; the future is inferred from the past only by the very inductive principle under question.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Hume does not abolish causal reasoning; he relocates necessity from an observed tie in objects to the mind's customary transition, thereby exposing induction as naturally indispensable but rationally underdetermined.

09

STAGE 09

COMPARATIVE SYNTHESIS, SCEPTICISM, PYQ ROUTES AND ANSWER SPINE

COMPARATIVE SYNTHESIS, SCEPTICISM, PYQ ROUTES AND ANSWER SPINE · MATTER RETAINED · QUALITY SPLIT · DEMONSTRATIVE GOD · NO MATTER · ALL SENSIBLE QUALITIES IDEAS · ORDERING GOD · NO SUBSTANCE IMPRESSION

LOCKE: matter retained / quality split / consciousness-self / demonstrative God → BERKELEY: no matter / all sensible qualities ideas / spirit-self / ordering God → HUME: no substance impression / perceptions / bundle-self / religion proof limits → SCEPTICISM: Locke limited realism → Berkeley anti-sceptical

SYSTEM / DOCTRINE

- LOCKE: matter retained / quality split / consciousness-self / demonstrative God
- BERKELEY: no matter / all sensible qualities ideas / spirit-self / ordering God
- HUME: no substance impression / perceptions / bundle-self / religion proof limits
- SCEPTICISM: Locke limited realism
- Berkeley anti-sceptical

DECISIVE DISTINCTION

- Hume mitigated
- REALISM: representative != direct; IDEALISM != denial of experience
- HUME: antecedent/excessive doubt rejected; custom/common life restore belief
- PYQ ROUTES: innate ideas; identity; primary qualities; nominalism; Berkeley reality
- PYQ ROUTES: Fork; causation; induction; bundle self; Kant response

EVALUATION / TRAP

- ANSWER: directive → thesis → definitions → argument → objection/reply → verdict
- CONTROL: claim → named text/example → analysis → qualification
- VERDICT: empiricism disciplines certainty but cannot rationally ground every belief.

MECHANISM / VERDICT — Philosophical doubt exposes the limits of reason, while natural instinct and custom re-establish action under a disciplined, probabilistic standard of belief.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Hume's mature position is sceptical naturalism: reason cannot vindicate induction, substance, a simple self or natural theology with necessity, yet custom and common life inevitably restore proportioned belief.

E

EXTRA

SUBORDINATE ENRICHMENT — ONLY AFTER THE COMPLETE CORE

OPTIONAL ADVANCED ENRICHMENT · ADVANCED SESSION 1 — THE MASTER SLIDE - REALISM · ADVANCED SESSION 2 — LOCKE - THEORY OF KNOWLEDGE · INNATE IDEAS, TABULA RASA, SOURCES AND DEGREES · ADVANCED SESSION 3 — LOCKE - ABSTRACT GENERAL IDEAS · ADVANCED SESSION 4 — LOCKE - QUALITIES AND SUBSTANCE · PRIMARY, SECONDARY AND THE KNOW-NOT-WHAT · ADVANCED SESSION 5 — LOCKE - SELF (PERSONAL IDENTITY)

OPTIONAL SOURCE WITNESS

- ADVANCED SESSION 1 — The Master Slide - Realism to Idealism to Scepticism
- ADVANCED SESSION 2 — Locke - Theory of Knowledge: Innate Ideas, Tabula Rasa, Sources and Degrees
- ADVANCED SESSION 3 — Locke - Abstract General Ideas, Nominal and Real Essence
- ADVANCED SESSION 4 — Locke - Qualities and Substance: Primary, Secondary and the Know-Not-What

ADVANCED OBJECTION

- ADVANCED SESSION 5 — Locke - Self (Personal Identity) and God
- ADVANCED SESSION 6 — Berkeley - Immaterialism, Esse Est Percipi and the Reconstructed Arguments
- ADVANCED SESSION 7 — Berkeley - Spirits, God, Common Sense: Moore and Russell React
- ADVANCED SESSION 8 — Hume - Impressions and Ideas, the Fork, Dissolved Substance and the Bundle Self

COMPARATIVE NUANCE

- ADVANCED SESSION 9 — Hume - Causation: Constant Conjunction, Custom and the Impression of Reflection
- ADVANCED SESSION 10 — Hume - Induction, Mitigated Scepticism, God, and the Empiricist-to-Idealist Map
- ADVANCED DOSSIER REFINEMENTS — USE SELECTIVELY
- Core prerequisite : finish the owner first for Theory of Knowledge

OPTIONAL STATUS — This optional depth is unnecessary for a competent core answer; use it only for added nuance after the complete core has been written.

END OF MASTER CANVAS • poster embeds this exact master • tiled pages are overlapping crops of the same pixels